

Juhi BP protocol

General guidelines for BP monitoring

- Take BP measurement twice a week. Let the days be spaced out so that there is a gap of 3-4 days between them
- Preferable timings of readings - between 8 am and 8 pm
- Be consistent - try to take the readings at approximately the same time in the day
- If taking twice a week, try taking in the morning one day and evening another day

Guidelines before and while taking the readings

- No coffee, tea, full bladder, heavy meal or a lot of physical exertion just before taking the readings
- Sit down for 10 mins (or at least 5) and only then take the readings.
- Rest your measuring hand (usually right) on a table
- Take 3 readings, separated by a gap of 2 minutes each. BP measurement is the average of those 3 readings (but no need to compute the average if writing the readings physically in a notebook).
- Confirm that the readings are within normal range
- **Normal range:** Between 90/60 and 135/90 (confirm with your doctor on this)
- Write down the readings in your notebook (Excel would have been preferable)

Note: Usually the right hand gives higher readings and hence should be the one chosen for measuring BP. You can try both hands (just once) to confirm this and pick the one that gives a higher reading for all future measurements

Guidelines for when all 3 readings are outside normal range

- If either upper or lower reading is above or below the normal range for all 3 readings then you need more frequent monitoring
- Take BP readings twice or at least once a day for 1 week
- If for several of those days, the readings are outside normal range, consult with your doctor immediately.
- If most days the readings are normal, then go back to twice a week frequency
- If the doctor changes dosage, it's important to take BP readings everyday to check the effect, say for a week.
 - If BP consistently remains outside normal range (can go too low also) report back to the doctor.
 - If it remains in range for a week, you can go back to twice-a-week monitoring.
Note - usually dosage change takes 2-3 days to create changes in BP

Other guidelines:

- Because of family history, apart from routine blood tests, a TMT (Treadmill Test) and Echocardiogram should be done in alternate years. A CT Angiography will give the most accurate picture of the arteries and can be considered. Calendar the appointments for the future so that too long a gap is avoided.
- Medicines need to be taken regularly. Consider keeping the medicines in a box with compartments for each day of the week - stock it once a week
- Diet and regular exercise are key components of keeping BP under control